English Orbit

PART 3 OF 6 / A2

Pre-intermediate

Tell stories, make plans and handle everyday situations.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

Open English Orbit to hear lesson passages and model sentences. Select this level and the matching lesson.

CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Tell stories, make plans and handle everyday situations.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 A weekend to remember | Past simple

02 Plans and possibilities | Going to & will

03 Choosing a place to stay | Comparatives & superlatives

04 Healthy habits | Should & everyday advice

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
6. Write a response, review it and revise at least one sentence.

> Suggested rhythm: 25-40 minutes in the app, plus 20-30 minutes of book practice per lesson. Take breaks and repeat difficult activities rather than rushing to the next level.

Use a notebook for extended answers. Listening can use the app, a teacher or a study partner. The PDF contains scripts and tasks; it does not contain embedded audio.

For open questions, wording may differ from the sample answers. For speaking and writing, use the review criteria; there is no single correct personal response.

A weekend to remember

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Past simple

01 / Read and notice

Last weekend, I visited my cousin in Brighton. We took a train to the coast and walked along the beach. The weather was cold, so we bought hot chocolate. I lost my ticket, but my cousin found it in my coat. We returned home after sunset.

Language focus

Regular past verbs add -ed: visited, walked. Irregular forms must be learned: take to took, buy to bought, find to found. Questions: Did you visit? Negatives: I didn't visit. Use the base verb after did.

Key words

coast - land beside the sea

ticket - proof you can travel or enter

coat - a warm outer garment

sunset - when the sun disappears

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A weekend to remember

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Why did they buy hot chocolate?

A. They missed the train / B. The weather was cold / C. They lost a ticket

2. Who found the lost ticket?

3. When did they return home?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: found / visited / did not take / bought / took

1. Last weekend I _____ my cousin.

2. We _____ a train.

3. We _____ hot chocolate.

4. My cousin _____ the ticket.

5. We _____ a bus.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A weekend to remember

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> We took a train to the coast and walked along the beach.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 60-80 words about a past outing. Include where, when, what happened and how you felt.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Plans and possibilities

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Going to & will

01 / Read and notice

Mina is going to start a photography course next month. She has already paid for it. She thinks it will help her find creative work. This weekend, she is going to buy a camera. Her brother says, "I'll come with you and help you choose."

Language focus

Use going to for a plan made earlier: I'm going to study. Use will for a prediction or an immediate decision: I think it will help. I'll help you. Both forms depend on the speaker's purpose.

Key words

photography - making pictures with a camera

creative - using imagination

choose - select

already - before now

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Plans and possibilities

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which action is already planned?

A. Her brother choosing a course / B. Mina starting a photography course / C. Mina teaching photography

2. What evidence shows the course is a prior plan?

3. What does her brother offer?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: is going to study / is going to start / will help / will come / are going to buy

1. She _____ a course next month: she has paid.

2. I think it _____ her.

3. A decision now: I _____ with you.

4. We _____ a camera: that is our plan.

5. He _____ tonight: he planned it yesterday.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Plans and possibilities

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> I am going to start a course. I think it will help me.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 60-80 words about your next month. Include two plans with going to and one prediction with will.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Choosing a place to stay

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Comparatives & superlatives

01 / Read and notice

The River Hotel is cheaper than the Central Hotel, but it is farther from the station. The Central Hotel has larger rooms and the fastest internet. The River Hotel is quieter. We chose the River Hotel because a good night's sleep mattered more to us than a large room.

Language focus

Short adjectives: cheap to cheaper to the cheapest. Longer adjectives: comfortable to more comfortable to the most comfortable. Irregular: good to better to best. Use than for comparisons.

Key words

farther - at a greater distance

quiet - with little noise

matter - be important

room - a space inside a building

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Choosing a place to stay

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Why did they choose the River Hotel?

A. It had the fastest internet / B. It was closest to the station / C. It was quieter

2. Which hotel has larger rooms?

3. What trade-off do they accept?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: quieter / fastest / larger / cheaper / better

1. The River Hotel is _____ than the Central Hotel.

2. The Central Hotel has _____ rooms.

3. It has the _____ internet.

4. The River Hotel is _____.

5. Good becomes _____ in the comparative.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Choosing a place to stay

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> The River Hotel is cheaper, but the Central Hotel has larger rooms.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Compare two places in 60-80 words. Include three comparisons and explain your choice.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Healthy habits

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Should & everyday advice

01 / Read and notice

Arun feels tired because he sleeps only five hours a night. His friend suggests a regular bedtime. "You should stop using your phone before bed," she says. "You shouldn't drink coffee late in the evening." Arun decides to try these changes for a week and see how he feels.

Language focus

Use should + base verb to give advice: You should rest. Use shouldn't for advice against something. Should is a recommendation, not a strict rule. Must expresses stronger obligation.

Key words

habit - something you do regularly

bedtime - the time you go to bed

suggest - offer an idea

regular - happening in a consistent pattern

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Healthy habits

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What does the friend advise against?

A. Sleeping regularly / B. Drinking coffee late / C. Trying changes

2. How long will Arun try the changes?

3. What causes his tiredness in the passage?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: base / should / should not / recommendation / rest

1. You _____ keep a regular bedtime.

2. You _____ drink coffee late.

3. After should, use the _____ verb.

4. You should _____, not resting.

5. Advice is a _____, not a strict rule.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Healthy habits

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> You should have a regular bedtime. You should not drink coffee late.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 60-80 words of advice to a friend who wants a better study routine. Use should and shouldn't.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Why did they buy hot chocolate?

A. They missed the train

B. The weather was cold

C. They lost a ticket

Reading reference: Lesson 1, A weekend to remember

02. Complete: Yesterday we ___ a train.

A. take

B. took

C. taking

Language focus review

03. Which action is already planned?

A. Her brother choosing a course

B. Mina starting a photography course

C. Mina teaching photography

Reading reference: Lesson 2, Plans and possibilities

04. Which expresses a prior plan?

A. I am going to buy a camera.

B. I buyed a camera.

C. I buying a camera.

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Why did they choose the River Hotel?

A. It had the fastest internet

B. It was closest to the station

C. It was quieter

Reading reference: Lesson 3, Choosing a place to stay

06. Complete: This room is ___ than that one.

A. large

B. largest

C. larger

Language focus review

07. What does the friend advise against?

A. Sleeping regularly

B. Drinking coffee late

C. Trying changes

Reading reference: Lesson 4, Healthy habits

08. Which gives advice?

A. You should to rest.

B. You should rest.

C. You should resting.

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / A weekend to remember

Reading 1: B. The weather was cold. The word "so" connects the cold weather to buying a hot drink.

Reading 2: The cousin found it.

Reading 3: After sunset.

Language practice: 1. visited; 2. took; 3. bought; 4. found; 5. did not take

Dictation: Last weekend, I visited my cousin in Brighton.

Lesson 2 / Plans and possibilities

Reading 1: B. Mina starting a photography course. Mina has paid already, so starting the course is a prior plan.

Reading 2: Mina has already paid for it.

Reading 3: To come with her and help her choose a camera.

Language practice: 1. is going to start; 2. will help; 3. will come; 4. are going to buy; 5. is going to study

Dictation: Mina is going to start a photography course next month.

Checkpoint answers

1. B: The word "so" connects the cold weather to buying a hot drink.
2. B: Took is the past form of take.
3. B: Mina has paid already, so starting the course is a prior plan.
4. A: Going to expresses an earlier plan.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / Choosing a place to stay

Reading 1: C. It was quieter. They valued sleep, so quietness was the deciding factor.

Reading 2: The Central Hotel.

Reading 3: They accept smaller rooms and a less central location for quietness.

Language practice: 1. cheaper; 2. larger; 3. fastest; 4. quieter; 5. better

Dictation: The River Hotel is cheaper than the Central Hotel, but it is farther from the station.

Lesson 4 / Healthy habits

Reading 1: B. Drinking coffee late. "You shouldn't drink coffee late" is advice to avoid that action.

Reading 2: One week.

Reading 3: Sleeping only five hours a night.

Language practice: 1. should; 2. should not; 3. base; 4. rest; 5. recommendation

Dictation: Arun feels tired because he sleeps only five hours a night.

Checkpoint answers

5. C: They valued sleep, so quietness was the deciding factor.
6. C: Use the comparative larger with than.

7. B: "You shouldn't drink coffee late" is advice to avoid that action.
8. B: Should is followed by a base verb.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Intermediate - Explain experiences, solve problems and give reasons.